REVELATION

The Apocalypse of John

-Extra Background-

The World?

"Earth"

"Ge"

"Land"

Geography of Revelation

- Examples in N.T.:
  - Luke 2:1 – census of whole world
  - Acts 2:5 – every nation under heaven
- Revelation 3:10?
  - Empire wide crisis, particular trials on those who live in Israel?

The "Coming" of Christ

- Is every "coming" mentioned the Second Coming of Christ?
- All 4 views believe in 2nd Coming
  - References in Revelation?
  - Some say all
  - Some say some are
  - Some even say none of them are!

The "Coming" of Christ

- Coming in spiritual sense:
  - 3:20 – "I will <u>come</u> in to you"
  - Jn 14:16-18 – "Spirit of truth… I am coming to you"
  - Jesus promising to come in person of Holy Spirit – "the Spirit of Christ"
  - Reference to Jesus "coming" in salvation

The "Coming" of Christ

- Coming to judge:
  - Prophets see God's sovereignty
  - God judges through other nations
  - Judgments described as God "coming"
  - "YHWH coming on a cloud" – Is. 19:1
  - "Jesus coming on the clouds" – Mt. 24:30
    - Assyrian invasion
    - 2nd Coming?

The "Coming" of Christ

- Coming to judge:
  - 2:5 – "coming" to Ephesus
  - 2:16 – "coming" to Pergamum
  - 3:3 – "coming" to Sardis
    - Churches no longer exist
    - Christ came to them – "removed their lamp stand"

The "Coming" of Christ

- "I am coming soon": (3:11, 22:7, 12)
  1. Second Coming but untrue
  2. Second Coming but "soon" means something else
  3. Not Second Coming – other event soon after writing

The "Coming" of Christ

1. Second Coming but untrue:
   - Revelation is false so un-canonical
   - Jesus is a liar!
   - Think we can ignore this option

The "Coming" of Christ

2. Second Coming but "soon" means something else:
   - "Suddenly" – speed not timing
   - "Certainly" – nothing to do with timing
   - "Day like a 1000 years" (2 Peter 3:8)
     - From Jesus' perspective still "soon"
     - But written to Humans!
     - 1000 years is like a 1000 years

The "Coming" of Christ

3. Not Second Coming – other event soon after writing:
   - A Judgment in history?
   - Mt. 16:28 – "not see death… Son of Man coming"
   - Mt. 10:23 – "not go through towns of Israel… before Son of Man comes"
   - Points towards "coming" within Disciple's lifetimes
   - 70 AD?

The "Coming" of Christ

- "I am coming" – not always about 2nd Coming
- Don't jump to conclusions
- If he meant something else:
  - Better to find out
  - Than make him mean 2nd Coming

O.T. Allusions

- Over 700 allusions to O.T.?
  - Exodus, Psalms, Prophets
- Comparison with Exodus:
  - 11:8 – evil power "spiritually" Egypt
  - Judgments similar to plagues
  - 1:5 – freed by the blood
  - The dragon (Egypt in Ps. 74 & Ez. 29)
  - Woman protected in the wilderness
  - 15:3 – song of Moses & the Lamb

O.T. Allusions

- Heavenly throne room
- "Theophanies" in O.T.:
  - Moses & God on Sinai (Ex. 19, 24)
  - Isaiah's vision (Is. 6)
  - Ezekiel's vision (Ez. 1)
  - Daniel's vision of Son of Man (Dan. 7)

O.T. Allusions

- Judgments echo O.T. judgments:
  - Plagues of Egypt (Ex. 6-10)
  - Sodom & Gomorrah (Gen. 19)
  - Gog & Magog (Ez. 38-39)
  - Torah curses (Deut. 28-29)
  - Ezekiel's prophecy against Tyre (Ez. 26-28)
- Judgments echo O.T. judgments:
  - Jeremiah's against Babylon (Jer. 50-51)
  - And Isaiah's (Is. 13-14)
  - Locusts (Joel)
  - Drinking cup of wrath (Jer. 25)
  - Winepress of God's wrath (Lam. 1)

O.T. Allusions

- New Jerusalem/Heaven/Earth:
  - Ezekiel's vision of Temple & Land (Ez. 40-48)
  - Isaiah's predictions of glorious Jerusalem & new heaven & earth (Is. 60, 65)
  - Similarity to Eden (Gen. 1-3)

Sea Metaphor

- Sea is used negatively throughout Scripture & A.N.E.
  - Represents evil/chaos
- Symbolical use of the sea in Revelation:
  - Sea of glass (4:6)
  - Dragon by the sea (12:17)
  - Beast rises from the sea (13:1)
  - Sea of glass mixed with fire (15:2)
  - Lake of fire (19:20, 20:10,14)
  - Sea was no more (21:1)

Sea Metaphor - The "Unholy Trinity"

- Job
  - Satan
  - Behemoth
  - Leviathan
- Two sea monsters & a land monster

- Revelation
  - Dragon
  - First Beast
  - Second Beast
- Two sea monsters and a land monster

Sea Metaphor - The Death of Evil

- Sea of Glass - Evil is frozen in the presence of God
- Sea of Glass mixed with fire - Evil is frozen in the presence of the conquering Church, & God's judgment has entered it
- Lake of fire - God's judgment has overcome Evil, it is consuming itself
- Sea was no more - Evil is gone forever

Use of Numbers

- 1 – unity, uniqueness
- 2 – companionship, added strength
- 3 – divine number, God
- 4 – creation, the world
- 6 – evil, fallenness
- 7 – completion, totality
- 10 – humanity, human power
- 12 – religion, covenant

Use of Numbers

- 3 ½ – half of time, before & after Messiah, yearning for completion, judgment
- 1000 – 10x10x10, Humanity or government made divine, long period of time
- 12,000 – perfect religious government/humanity
- 144,000 – 12x12x10x10x10 the above in companionship

Structure

- Visions chronological?
- Order John saw
- Order they will happen?
- Parallels within the book
- If so, how many?

Structure

- Some Futurists:
  - 4-11 – Tribulation
  - 12-19 – Tribulation
  - Heaven?
  - Earth?

- Idealists:
  - 7 parallels
  - 1-3 – 7 Churches
  - 4-7 – 7 Seals
  - 8-11 – 7 Trumpets
  - 12-14 – 7 Signs
  - 15-16 – 7 Bowls
  - 17-19 – Victory over the Beasts
  - 20-22 – Final Victory & Eternity

Structure

- Drama?
  - 2 Acts, 7 scenes?
- Three battles?:
  - 16:14, 19:19 & 20:
- Order of events
  - Beast rises – 13:1
  - Beast persecutes witnesses – 11:7

Structure

- The Sevens?
- Progression?:
  - 7 Seals – Judgment Prepared
  - 7 Trumpets – Judgment Partial
  - 7 Bowls – Judgment Permanent
  - 7th Seal=7 Trumpets
  - 7th Trumpet=7Bowls

- Parallels between Trumpets & Bowls:
  - 1st – Earth
  - 2nd – Sea
  - 3rd – Rivers
  - 4th – Heavenly Bodies
  - 5th – People
  - 6th – Euphrates
  - 7th – The End

Structure

- Points to some level of Parallels
- But not absolute
- Affect your interpretation:
  - E.g. chapters 19 & 20
  - 20 follow 19?
  - 20 beginning of new parallel?

Chiasm???????

The Bride of the Lamb (7 Churches)
The Authority of the Lamb (Heavenly Court)
The City is attacked (7 Seals)
The Wicked are judged (7 Trumpets)
Worship the Lamb or beast? (7 Signs)
The Wicked are judged (7 Bowls)
The City is fallen (Babylon)
The Victory of the Lamb (Final Battle)
The Bride of the Lamb (New Jerusalem)

Who do you worship?

The eternal victory of the Lamb

The conquering Church

Chiasm???????

1:1-20 Prologue & Greeting
2:1-3:22 Seven Churches
4:1-8:5 Seven Seals
8:6-11:19 Seven Trumpets-Angels-Two Witnesses
12:1-17 Woman, Dragon, & Male Child
13:1-16:21 Two Beasts-Angels-Seven Bowls
17:1-19:10 Destruction of Babylon
19:11-22:5 New Jerusalem, the Bride
22:6-21 Closing & Epilogue

From "Charts on the Book of Revelation" by Mark Wilson